Cake Themes Templates

Product Vision & Creative Direction Brief

Project: The Next Generation of Cake & Bakery Commerce

Phase 1: Design and Development of Five Signature Storefront Templates

1. Our Ambition

We are setting out to create some of the most beautiful, delightful, intuitive, and commercially effective digital ordering experiences available to independent cake and bakery brands.
Our ambition is not to build another collection of e-commerce templates.
We want to rethink the experience of discovering, choosing, customizing, gifting, and purchasing cakes online.
Imagine the creative originality and execution quality of a world-class independent design studio, combined with the usability discipline of an exceptional consumer technology company and the commercial effectiveness of a high-performing e-commerce business.
That is the standard we are pursuing.
We want a customer to encounter one of our storefronts and feel that ordering a cake is an enjoyable experience in itself.
At the same time, we want bakery owners to see a product that can help them attract customers, convert more visitors into buyers, increase order values, and generate repeat purchases.
Our guiding principle: Exceptional creativity must enhance commercial performance, never come at its expense.

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2. Our Target Market

We are designing primarily for independent cake shops, boutique bakeries, artisan cake studios, and growing bakery brands in Western markets.
Our initial geographic focus will be the United States, United Kingdom, Canada, Australia, and comparable markets.
Our target merchants may include:

- Independent cake shops selling birthday and celebration cakes.
- Boutique bakeries with strong visual identities.
- Custom cake designers handling personalized orders.
- Premium bakeries selling cakes, pastries, and gift collections.
- Growing bakery brands operating one or multiple locations.

These businesses care about how their brands are perceived, but they also care deeply about sales, operational simplicity, customer retention, and profitability.
Our templates must address both sets of needs.

3. What We Are Building

Our first deliverable is a collection of **five exceptionally crafted storefront templates**.
Each template must have its own creative concept, visual identity, emotional character, and distinctive interactions.
We do not want five variations of the same design.
We want five different interpretations of what an extraordinary cake-ordering experience could be.
However, every template must share a common foundation of excellent usability, robust commerce functionality, accessibility, responsiveness, and performance.
Creative diversity at the presentation layer. Consistency and reliability at the commerce layer.

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4. Our Creative Standard

We want the quality of creative thinking and execution associated with the world's most respected independent branding, digital experience, and interactive design studios.
This does not mean adopting any particular national aesthetic.
It means demonstrating:
Conceptual originality
Every template must begin with a strong creative idea. The idea should inform the experience, rather than simply decorate it.
Exceptional art direction
Typography, colour, imagery, composition, illustration, and visual storytelling must feel deliberate, distinctive, and cohesive.
Beautiful interaction design
The way customers browse, discover, customize, and purchase products should be carefully choreographed, with delightful but purposeful interactions.
Obsessive craftsmanship
Spacing, animation timing, hover states, loading experiences, transitions, responsive behaviour, and microcopy deserve serious attention.
Emotional intelligence
People purchase cakes to celebrate, express affection, mark milestones, and create memories.
Our experiences should understand and amplify these motivations.
We are not interested in generic templates made visually attractive through superficial animation.
We are interested in original digital experiences that feel thoughtfully authored.

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5. Our User Experience Standard

Our target customer is not a design professional or a technology enthusiast.
It is an ordinary person who wants to purchase a cake.
The experience must therefore remain exceptionally easy to understand and use.
A customer should be able to visit the website, understand what is being sold, discover an appropriate cake, understand the price, choose the necessary options, and complete a purchase without requiring instructions.
We must support two broad customer behaviours:
The Express Buyer
This customer knows what they want and wants to purchase quickly.
We must not force them through elaborate animations, excessive storytelling, or unnecessary customization steps.

The Exploratory Buyer
This customer wants inspiration, discovery, personalization, and perhaps the enjoyment of creating something special.
We should provide an immersive, delightful experience without making it confusing.
Both journeys are equally important.
Our design decisions must consistently reduce friction, increase confidence, create desire, or introduce meaningful delight.

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6. Our Commercial Standard

We are building commerce products, not digital art exhibitions.
The success of a template must ultimately be measured by its contribution to merchant outcomes.
The team must design with the following metrics in mind:

- Visitor-to-purchase conversion rate.
- Revenue per visitor.
- Average order value.
- Product discovery and selection rates.
- Cart and checkout abandonment.
- Repeat purchase rate.
- Customer satisfaction.
- Mobile conversion performance.

We should explore how the ordering experience can naturally encourage customers to purchase complementary items, upgrade products, personalize gifts, and return for future occasions.
These opportunities should feel helpful rather than manipulative.
Commercial assumptions must be validated through usability testing, analytics, and controlled experiments wherever feasible.

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7. Essential Cake & Bakery Commerce Capabilities

Each template must support the core realities of operating a cake or bakery business.
These include:
Product discovery

- Browse by product category, occasion, collection, or other relevant attributes.
- Clear product imagery, descriptions, pricing, and availability.
- Effective navigation and search where appropriate.

Product customization

- Cake size and servings.
- Flavours and fillings.
- Frosting or design options.

- Cake inscriptions.
- Optional decorations and add-ons.
- Product-specific customization rules.
- Clear price changes as selections are made.

Ordering and fulfilment

- Pickup and local delivery.
- Delivery or pickup date selection.
- Lead times and ordering cutoffs.
- Fulfilment capacity and availability restrictions.
- Location-based delivery eligibility and fees.
- Clear order summaries and confirmation.

Gifting

- Personalized messages.
- Gift packaging where available.
- Recipient information.
- Scheduled delivery.
- Thoughtful complementary product recommendations.

Checkout

- Transparent total pricing.
- Relevant local payment methods.
- Mobile-friendly forms.
- Guest checkout.
- Clear error handling and payment recovery.

The underlying system must allow merchants to configure which capabilities apply to their businesses.
Not every bakery offers custom cakes, delivery, or every personalization option.
The experience must accurately reflect what each merchant can fulfil.

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8. The Five Initial Creative Directions

These are starting territories for exploration, not predetermined final designs.

Template 01 — The Editorial Atelier

An art-directed, sophisticated experience where cakes are presented as beautifully crafted objects.
Emphasis: premium perception, photography, typography, elegant discovery, and refined interaction.

Template 02 — The Playful Celebration

A joyful, expressive, imaginative storefront with memorable interactions and an energetic visual personality.
Emphasis: emotional delight, celebration, discovery, and gifting.

Template 03 — The Romantic Boutique

An intimate, thoughtful, highly personalized experience built around affection, meaningful occasions, and gifting.
Emphasis: storytelling, personalization, emotional connection, and presentation.

Template 04 — The Contemporary Creative Studio

A bold, experimental design language with unusual compositions, expressive typography, and inventive interactions.
Emphasis: originality, differentiation, and artistic identity.

Template 05 — The Modern Neighbourhood Bakery

A warm, welcoming, highly intuitive experience designed around everyday ordering, local trust, convenience, and repeat purchases.
Emphasis: usability, accessibility, efficient purchasing, and operational clarity.
Each direction should be challenged and refined through merchant research and creative exploration.
We are not committed to these five concepts if stronger opportunities emerge.

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9. Required Design Process

We do not want the team to jump straight into designing five homepages.
The process should include:

Stage 1 — Market and experience research

Study successful cake and bakery brands in our target markets.
Understand how their customers currently discover and order products.
Identify customer frustrations, unmet needs, common operational constraints, and opportunities to differentiate.
Study exceptional digital experiences beyond the bakery industry.

Stage 2 — Creative concept development

Develop distinct creative territories for the five templates.
Each proposal should articulate its concept, target merchant, emotional character, visual language, interaction principles, and commercial rationale.

Stage 3 — Customer journey architecture

Design the complete experience from arrival to purchase confirmation.
Identify opportunities for delight, points of friction, and moments where the customer needs reassurance.

Stage 4 — High-fidelity experience design

Produce complete designs covering desktop and mobile, including all essential commerce states.
Pay particular attention to interaction quality, responsive behaviour, product customization, and checkout.

Stage 5 — Interactive prototyping and validation

Build realistic prototypes of the most important customer journeys.
Test with representative users, including people with limited technical confidence.
Identify confusion, hesitation, unnecessary steps, and usability failures.

Stage 6 — Engineering and quality assurance

Develop the approved templates on a reusable technical foundation.
Validate performance, accessibility, commerce reliability, and consistency with the creative vision.

Stage 7 — Merchant validation and refinement

Test the templates with prospective bakery merchants.
Confirm that the designs can accommodate real catalogues, operating rules, and brand identities.
Refine based on observed usability and commercial performance.

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10. Required Deliverables

For the first five templates, we expect:

1. Market and competitor research.
2. Five distinct creative concept documents.
3. Moodboards and art-direction systems.
4. Customer journey maps and information architecture.
5. Complete desktop and mobile interface designs.
6. Interactive prototypes of critical ordering experiences.
7. Shared design-system foundations.
8. Template-specific visual and motion guidelines.
9. Production-ready implementations.
10. Accessibility, usability, and performance testing reports.
11. Merchant configuration and customization guidelines.
12. Analytics instrumentation and a conversion-testing plan.

Every template must demonstrate a complete working purchase journey, not merely an impressive homepage.

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11. What We Will Not Accept

We will not accept:

- Generic e-commerce templates with cosmetic changes.
- Five designs that share essentially the same creative identity.
- Beautiful interfaces that are difficult to navigate.
- Excessive animations that slow down purchasing.
- Design concepts that only work with perfect demonstration content.
- Desktop-first designs with poorly adapted mobile experiences.
- Customization experiences that ignore real bakery operations.
- Aesthetic decisions that make prices, availability, or actions difficult to understand.
- Templates that look impressive in Figma but cannot be faithfully implemented.
- Unsubstantiated claims that a creative feature will increase sales.

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12. Our Definition of Success

Our first five templates should establish a clear new standard for what cake and bakery e-commerce can look and feel like.

They should be distinctive enough to earn admiration from excellent designers, intuitive enough for ordinary customers to use effortlessly, and commercially compelling enough for independent bakery owners to want them for their businesses.

Ultimately, we want to make exceptional digital design commercially accessible to independent bakery brands. **We are not merely designing websites for cake shops. We are designing a better way for people to discover, personalize, gift, and buy cakes.**

That is the assignment.